

Deployment Guide

This project consists of three main components:

1. **Frontend** → React (Vite) application
 2. **Backend** → Strapi (API + Admin Dashboard)
 3. **Database** → MySQL (Restored via Strapi backup)
-



1. Project Structure

```
project/
├── client/
├── strapi/
│   ├── final-backup.tar.gz.enc  # Encrypted DB backup (IMPORTANT)
│   └── ...
└── README.pdf
```



2. Frontend (React - Vite)

2.1 Install dependencies

```
cd client
npm install
```

2.2 Environment variables (Frontend)

There are `.env` file inside client folder:

```
/client/.env
```

Contain the API URL:

```
VITE_STRAPI_URL=http://localhost:1337
```

 Explanation

This variable defines the **API URL of the Strapi backend** that the frontend (React application) will communicate with.

⚠️ VERY IMPORTANT (Production Setup)

After deployment, this value **MUST be updated** to the actual backend URL.

Example:

If Strapi is deployed on:

```
https://api.yourdomain.com
```

Then update `/client/.env` to:

```
VITE_STRAPI_URL=https://api.yourdomain.com
```

❌ If not configured correctly

- Frontend will NOT load data
- API requests will fail
- Website will appear empty or broken

2.3 Build frontend

```
npm run build
```

2.4 Output

```
/dist
```

Deploy `/dist` to your web server (Nginx / Apache / hosting).

3. Backend (Strapi)

3.1 Install dependencies

```
cd strapi
npm install
npm install mysql2
```

3.2 Environment variables (REQUIRED)

The `.env` file already exists inside the `/strapi` folder :

```
/strapi/.env
```

The deployment team must update the **database credentials** inside this file according to the production MySQL server.

Update these values:

```
HOST=0.0.0.0
PORT=1337

DATABASE_CLIENT=mysql
DATABASE_HOST=localhost
DATABASE_PORT=3306
DATABASE_NAME=qnh_db
DATABASE_USERNAME=root
DATABASE_PASSWORD=yourpassword
```

⚠ Important

- `DATABASE_HOST` must be the MySQL server host.
- `DATABASE_PORT` is usually `3306`.
- `DATABASE_NAME` must match the database created in MySQL.
- `DATABASE_USERNAME` and `DATABASE_PASSWORD` must be the real MySQL credentials provided by the hosting/server.
- Make sure these values are correct **before running Strapi or importing the backup**.

The other existing Strapi secret values should remain as they are unless the deployment team needs to change them:

● 4. Database Setup & Restore (CRITICAL)

4.1 Create MySQL database

```
CREATE DATABASE qnh_db
CHARACTER SET utf8mb4
COLLATE utf8mb4_unicode_ci;
```

4.2 Initialize Strapi (create tables)

```
npm run develop
```

Wait until Strapi starts successfully, then stop:

```
CTRL + C
```

4.3 Restore Data

The backup file is located inside `/strapi`:

```
final-backup.tar.gz.enc
```

Run:

```
npx strapi import --file final-backup.tar.gz.enc --key qnh123
```

When prompted:

```
The import will delete your existing data
```

Type:

```
Yes
```

IMPORTANT

- This will **delete existing MySQL data only**
- It will NOT affect any other database

- Make sure `.env` database configuration is correct BEFORE import
- It restores:
 - All content
 - Media files
 - Users & roles
 - Relations
 - CMS configuration



Backup Key

Encryption Key: qnh123



This key MUST be used during import.

4.4 Start in production

```
npm run build
npm start
```



5. Domain & Routing

```
yourdomain.com      → React frontend
api.yourdomain.com  → Strapi backend
```



6. System Flow

```
User → React (Frontend)
React → Strapi API
Strapi → MySQL Database

Admin → /admin panel
```



7. Important Notes

✗ Do NOT use:

```
npm run dev
```

✓ Use:

```
npm run build  
npm start
```



8. Summary

Component	Action
React	<code>npm run build</code> → deploy <code>/dist</code>
Strapi	<code>npm run build && npm start</code>
Database	Restore via <code>strapi import</code>



Support

For deployment assistance or issues, contact the developer.